

SELL MORE ONLINE

Product Photos That Sell

Shoot-at-Home Photography for Etsy & Small Shops

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\$34 value

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Shoot-at-Home Photography for Etsy & Small Shops. Written for etsy, Shopify & Amazon sellers photographing their own products.

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INTRODUCTION

Your Photo Is the Only Salesperson You Get

A shopper will never hold your product, smell it, feel its weight, or turn it over in their hands. They will look at a photo on a screen the size of a playing card and decide, in about two seconds, whether you are worth their money. That photo is not "part of" your listing — it *is* your storefront, your salesperson, and your first impression, all at once. This guide teaches you to shoot photos that do that job, at home, with the gear you already own.

Here is the truth most sellers learn too late: **the product is not what sells. The photo of the product is what sells.** Two shops can list the identical handmade candle. One photographs it on a cluttered kitchen counter under a yellow ceiling bulb; the other on a clean, bright, softly lit sweep with one thoughtful prop. Same candle. The second shop sells three times as many — and can often charge more, because the photo signals "this is a real, trustworthy business."

THE WHOLE GUIDE IN ONE SENTENCE

Better photos are the cheapest, fastest, highest-return upgrade you can make to your shop — nothing else you spend \$34 on will move sales as reliably as learning to light and shoot your own product well.

Why this pays for itself

Think in terms of return, because that is the only honest way to think about it. If your main photo lifts your click-through rate on a marketplace search page even slightly, more people land on your listing. If those listing photos then convert a few more of those visitors into buyers, the effect compounds every single day, across every product, for as long as your shop is open. You are not buying a skill. You are buying a permanent multiplier on traffic you are already paying to attract.



Phone or camera — both work

Everything in this guide works with a modern smartphone *or* a dedicated camera. Good product photography is 80% light and setup and 20% gear. A phone in great light beats a \$2,000 camera in bad light every time. Where a setting differs between a phone and a camera, this guide gives you both.

How to use this guide

Read Chapters 2 and 3 first — the studio setup and the lighting. They are the foundation everything else stands on, and they are where most home sellers go wrong. Then work through settings, the white-background shot, and styling. Chapter 9 gives you a repeatable shot list you will use on every product from now on, and Chapter 10 turns your photos into clicks and sales. Keep it practical: read a chapter, then go shoot.

Buyers can't touch your product. The photo does 100% of the selling — so make it do the job.

CHAPTER 1

The \$30 Home Studio

You do not need a studio. You need a window, something white to bounce light, and a clean surface. That is genuinely most of it. The photography world will happily sell you ring lights, colored gels, and \$400 "product tables," and you will not need any of it to make photos that outsell 90% of your competition. Let's separate what actually matters from what is marketing.

What you actually need

A window

A medium-to-large window that gets bright, **indirect** daylight is the best light source you own, and it's free. North-facing is ideal (soft all day), but any window works if you manage the sun.

A bounce card

A piece of white foam board or a white poster board from the dollar store. This "fills" the dark side of your product with soft light. It is the single most important \$2 you will spend.

A sweep / backdrop

A large sheet of white paper, poster board, or a roll of craft paper curved from table to wall behind the product. It removes the horizon line and gives you that clean, seamless look.

A cheap tripod

Any tripod — even a \$15 phone tripod — keeps the camera dead still so you can use crisp, low-ISO settings and shoot a whole catalog from the identical angle.

The whole kit, itemized

White foam board or poster board (bounce): \$2. Second board or craft-paper roll (sweep): \$5–10. Phone or camera tripod: \$15. A roll of matte white or neutral paper for backgrounds: \$8. That is a complete product studio for around \$30. Everything else is optional.

What you can skip (for now)

Don't buy these first

Ring lights throw an ugly donut reflection onto anything shiny and give flat, characterless light. **Cheap LED panels** often have a green or magenta color cast that wrecks your product's true color. **Novelty backdrops** (fake wood, marble contact paper) look cheap on camera. Master the window and the bounce before you spend a dime on artificial light.

The one accessory worth considering: a lightbox

A collapsible lightbox (light tent) is a fabric cube with built-in or add-your-own lighting and a seamless white interior. For **small items** — jewelry, cosmetics, small crafts — it delivers clean, consistent, shadow-controlled shots with almost no setup, and folds flat between shoots. If your products fit inside one and you shoot many small SKUs, a \$30–50 lightbox can be the best convenience purchase in this whole guide. For anything larger than a shoebox, skip it and use the window.



Lightbox reality check

A lightbox is a shortcut to *consistency*, not to *beauty*. It's perfect for the clean catalog shot and useless for lifestyle photos. Buy one if you sell small items and value speed; don't buy one expecting it to make styled, story-driven photos.

Your setup checklist

- ☒ A window with bright, indirect daylight — no direct sun beam hitting the product.
- ☒ A sturdy table pulled near the window, side-on to the light.
- ☒ A sweep: paper or board curving up from the tabletop to the wall behind.
- ☒ A white bounce card on the shadow side, opposite the window.
- ☒ A tripod so every shot is sharp and every product is framed identically.
- ☒ A tidy space — no clutter, cords, or reflections sneaking into frame.

CHAPTER 2

Light It So It Looks Expensive

Expensive-looking photos almost always come down to one thing: **big, soft light**. Cheap-looking photos come from small, hard light — a bare bulb, a phone flash, a point-source LED. Once you understand that single idea, you can make a \$12 product look like a \$60 one, and you'll never reach for that on-camera flash again.

Big and soft beats small and hard

"Soft" light wraps gently around your product, with shadows that fade off smoothly. "Hard" light comes from a small source and slams down harsh, sharp-edged shadows that look cheap and amateur. The rule of physics behind it is simple: **the larger the light source is relative to your product, the softer the light**. A big window a few feet from a small item is enormous by comparison — which is exactly why window light looks so good.

REMEMBER

Soft light sells. A large window, or any large diffused source, wraps your product in flattering light that makes texture and color read true. Small hard light (bulbs, flash) makes everything look cheap.

The one-light recipe

You do not need three lights. You need one great light and something to bounce it back. Here is the setup that works for almost every product:

1

Put the window to one side of your product.

Side light (light coming from the left or right, roughly 45–90° off the camera) reveals texture and shape — the qualities that make a product look real and touchable.

2

Place your bounce card on the opposite side.

The window lights one side; the shadow side goes too dark; the white card catches spill light and throws it softly back in. Now both sides read, with gentle dimension in between.

3

Adjust the gap between product and card.

Card closer = brighter fill, softer shadows. Card farther = deeper shadows, more drama. Slide it until the shadow side looks natural, not muddy.

Classic clean product light

STARTING POINT

Source **Large window**

Angle **45-90° side**

Fill **White bounce, shadow side**

Time **Midday, indirect**

Bright but no direct sun beam. If shadows are too harsh, diffuse the window (below). If the shadow side is too dark, slide the bounce card closer.

When the sun is harsh, diffuse it

Direct sunlight blasting through the window is small and hard — it creates ugly, high-contrast shadows and blown-out hot spots. Don't fight it; soften it. Tape a sheet of white tracing paper, a thin white bedsheet, or a shower curtain over the window. Suddenly the whole window becomes your soft light source, and harsh sun becomes beautiful.



The sheer-curtain trick

A cheap white sheer curtain across a sunny window is the fastest softbox you'll ever own. It turns a harsh beam into a big, even, flattering wash of light. Keep one pinned up wherever you shoot.

The mistake that ruins color: mixed light

The most common home-photo killer is **mixing light of different colors** — daylight from the window plus a warm yellow ceiling bulb plus a bluish LED. Each has a different color temperature, so your product ends up half-warm, half-cool, and impossible to color-correct. Your camera can only balance for one.



Turn off the room lights

When you shoot by a window, switch off every overhead and lamp in the room. Let the window be your *only* light source. One color of light in, one clean color to correct. This one habit fixes more "why do my photos look off?" problems than anything else.



Think in gradients, not flat

Beginners try to eliminate every shadow and end up with flat, lifeless photos. Pros keep a gentle gradient — a little brighter on the light side, a little softer on the fill side. That subtle falloff is what tells the eye "this is a real, three-dimensional object," and it's what makes a product look premium.

CHAPTER 3

Camera & Phone Settings for Crisp Products

Product photography has a different priority than portraits or landscapes: you usually want the **entire product sharp**, front to back, edge to edge. That single goal drives every setting below. Blurry or partially-soft product photos read as low-quality and cost you sales, so let's lock in crisp.

Aperture: stop down for full sharpness

That dreamy blurry-background look (wide aperture, low f-number) is wrong for most product shots — it throws part of your product out of focus. You want **depth of field**, so stop down. Around **f/8** is the classic product aperture: enough depth to keep the whole item sharp, without pushing so far that diffraction softens the image.

Sharp-everywhere product settings (camera)

STARTING POINT

Aperture **f/8**

ISO **100**

Shutter **Whatever balances (tripod)**

Mode **Aperture Priority (A/Av)**

On a tripod, shutter speed doesn't matter for sharpness — the camera can take as long as it needs. Set aperture and ISO; let shutter float. For tiny items needing even more depth, go f/11.



Don't over-stop-down

It's tempting to crank to f/22 for "maximum sharpness," but past roughly f/11–f/16 **diffraction** actually softens the whole frame. Live around f/8; only push to f/11 when a deep item genuinely needs it.

ISO: keep it low, keep it clean

Because your camera is on a tripod and your product is not moving, you have no reason to raise ISO. Set it to your camera's base — **ISO 100** (or 64/200 depending on brand). Low ISO means no grain, maximum detail, and the cleanest color. This is a luxury still-life photography gives you that action photography never does; use it.

Tripod and timer: the free sharpness upgrade

1 Mount the camera or phone on the tripod.

This alone lets you use base ISO and any shutter speed without a hint of shake.

2 Use the 2-second self-timer

(or a remote / your phone's timer). Even pressing the shutter button nudges the camera; the timer lets that vibration settle before the shot fires.

3 Frame once, shoot the whole catalog.

With the rig locked down, every product is photographed from the identical height and angle — instant catalog consistency, no extra effort.

White balance: get color right in-camera

Your product's color must be accurate — a mustard scarf that photographs orange gets returned, and returns quietly destroy small shops. If you're shooting in one color of light (as Chapter 2 insists), set white balance to match:

Daylight/Sunny for window light. Even better, shoot in **RAW** if your camera allows, so you can fine-tune color perfectly later with zero quality loss.

The gray card / white card trick

Photograph a plain neutral-gray or pure-white card in your scene as your first frame. In editing, click it with the white-balance eyedropper and your color snaps to perfectly accurate — then apply that correction to every photo from the same setup. It's how catalogs keep color identical across hundreds of shots.

Tiny items: focus stacking basics

For very small products shot up close — a ring, a small pin — even f/11 may not keep the whole thing sharp, because closeness shrinks depth of field dramatically. The pro fix is **focus stacking**: take several identical shots, each focused on a different slice (front, middle, back), then blend them in software so the whole item is sharp. Many phones and cameras have automated versions; free and paid apps can blend the stack for you.



You rarely need to stack

Focus stacking is a niche tool for extreme close-ups. For most products, f/8–f/11 on a tripod keeps everything sharp in a single frame. Reach for stacking only when you're shooting macro-close on a deep, tiny object and one shot can't hold it all.

Shooting on a phone

Phones don't give you an aperture dial, but you get the same results with equivalent moves:



Lock focus & exposure

Tap your product to focus, then press-and-hold to lock (AE/AF Lock) so the phone can't drift between shots. Turn **off** Portrait mode — you want everything sharp, not a fake blur.



Use the timer & grid

Turn on the 3-second timer to avoid shake, and enable the gridlines to keep products level and centered. Clean the lens — a fingerprint smear is the #1 cause of hazy phone photos.



Set white balance

Use a pro/manual camera app (or lock WB in your camera app) so color stays consistent. Avoid mixing light exactly as a camera would.



Don't zoom — move

Pinch-zoom degrades quality. Physically move the phone closer, or shoot a touch wider and crop later. Use the main (1×) lens, which is sharpest.

CHAPTER 4

The Clean White-Background Shot

Every product needs one non-negotiable photo: the clean, bright, distraction-free shot on white. It's what marketplaces expect, what shoppers scan for, and what makes a catalog look professional. Some marketplaces don't just prefer it — they **require** it.

Know your marketplace's rules

Amazon requires the **main image** of most products to be on a **pure white background** (specifically RGB 255, 255, 255), with the product filling roughly 85% of the frame, no props, no text, no logos, no watermarks. Etsy and Shopify are far more flexible and let you lead with styled photos — but even there, a clean white shot belongs somewhere in your set, because it's the clearest possible look at the actual item. Check your specific platform's image spec and shoot to the strictest one you sell on.



Pure white is a real spec, not a vibe

"Looks white" isn't the same as RGB 255. Amazon's system reads actual pixel values. If your background photographs as light gray (say 240, 240, 240), it can fail. You'll hit true white by exposing correctly *and* cleaning up in editing — both steps below.

Expose for the white

Cameras are built to make everything average out to mid-gray, so pointing one at a white background makes it *underexpose* — your bright white comes out dull gray. The fix is to deliberately overexpose:

1

Add exposure compensation.

Dial in **+1 to +1.7 stops** (or slide your phone's exposure up) until the background reads bright white without the product itself blowing out and losing detail.

2

Watch the product, not the background.

The goal is a bright background *and* a correctly-exposed product. If pushing the background to white overexposes the product, you need more separation — move the product farther from the backdrop, or light the background separately.

3

Light the background if you can.

A second window, lamp, or bounce aimed at the sweep behind the product blows it clean white while your main light handles the product. Separation of the two is the pro secret to effortless white.

Pure-white background shot

MARKETPLACE-READY

Aperture **f/8**ISO **100**Exposure **+1 to +1.7**Backdrop **White sweep, lit separately**

Product fills ~85% of frame, centered, level, on a tripod. Finish the last few percent of white in editing.

Simple background cleanup

Even a good in-camera white usually needs a final nudge to hit true 255. In any editor, raise the exposure/whites on the background until it reads pure white, then use a brush or "whiten background" tool to clean the corners and remove stray shadows or dust. For a flawless result, some sellers cut the product out and drop it onto a pure-white layer. Keep a soft, natural contact shadow under the product if your marketplace allows it — it stops the item from looking like it's floating.

Consistency across the catalog

CONSISTENCY IS TRUST

A shop where every white-background shot is the same brightness, angle, and framing looks like a real business. A shop where each photo is a different shade of "white" at a different angle looks like a hobby. Shoppers feel the difference even when they can't name it.

- ☒ Same background, same distance, same angle for every product.
- ☒ Same exposure settings, dialed in once and reused.
- ☒ Same white-balance correction applied across the batch (use that gray-card frame).
- ☒ Product centered and level, filling a consistent portion of the frame.
- ☒ Export at the same dimensions and aspect ratio every time.

CHAPTER 5

Styled & Lifestyle Shots That Convert

The clean white shot proves what the product *is*. The styled shot sells what the product *does* — and it's usually the photo that earns the click and closes the sale. This is where you show scale, use, and a little story, and where you get to differentiate from every other seller listing the same white-background item.

Props with a purpose

Props are not decoration; they're information. Each one should answer a buyer's silent question. A coffee mug beside your candle says "this is cozy-home sized." A hand holding your earrings says "this is how big they actually are and how they'll look on you." Choose props that **support the product** and never steal focus from it.



The hero must stay the hero

The single most common styling mistake is props that overwhelm the product. If a viewer's eye lands on your beautiful vintage tray instead of the soap you're selling, the shot failed. Keep the product biggest, sharpest, and best-lit. Everything else supports.

Show scale — always

Online, buyers cannot judge size, and a wrong guess means a return. Give them a reference in at least one photo:



In-hand

Holding the item instantly communicates size and invites the viewer to imagine holding it themselves. Perfect for jewelry, small goods, gadgets.



On-model / in-use

Worn, used, or placed in a real setting — a scarf on a person, a print on a wall, a bag on a shoulder. Shows fit, drape, and proportion at once.



Next to a known object

A common reference — a coin, a book, a plant — silently answers "how big is this?" Use when a hand or model doesn't fit the vibe.



In context

The product where it'll live: mug on a desk, print in a room, planter on a shelf. Helps the buyer picture it in *their* space.

The flat lay

Shooting straight down onto an arranged scene — the flat lay — is a workhorse for small goods, sets, and anything that reads well from above. Shoot it directly overhead (a tripod with a horizontal arm, or the phone held flat and level), on a clean surface, with props arranged to guide the eye toward the product. Leave breathing room; don't cram the frame.

Try this: the three-photo story

For your next product, shoot three lifestyle frames that tell a mini-story: (1) the product in use, (2) a close detail that shows quality, (3) the product in the setting where a buyer would enjoy it. Line them up in your listing. You've just walked the buyer from "what is it" to "I want it."



Borrow the negative space

Styled shots with clean empty space around the product don't just look premium — that space is where marketplace overlays, sale badges, and your own text can go later without covering the product. Compose a little loose on purpose.

CHAPTER 6

Tricky Materials, Solved

Some products fight back. Shiny things throw reflections of you and your room; transparent things vanish; dark things turn to muddy blobs; texture goes flat. Each has a specific, reliable trick — here they are, one material at a time.

Reflective & shiny (jewelry, glass, metal)

Shiny surfaces mirror everything around them, including *you*. Surround the item with white — shoot inside a lightbox or a ring of white boards so it reflects clean white, not clutter. Use a large soft source, kill hard hotspots by diffusing, and shoot slightly off-axis so your lens isn't staring back at you in the reflection.

Transparent (glass, bottles, resin)

Clear items disappear on white. Give them **edges**: light the background bright so the object's outline reads, or place thin dark cards just out of frame on each side so the edges catch a defining dark line. Backlighting through the object makes it glow and shows clarity.

Dark products (black items)

Dark objects lose all shape on a dark or even neutral background and confuse the camera's meter. Add a subtle rim of light or a light-gray background for separation, brighten the exposure a touch so detail emerges, and use side light to rake across the surface and reveal form and edges.

Textured & fabric (knits, wood, leather)

Texture is the selling point — so *light it to show*. Use strong side light (window at 90°) so the raking light casts tiny shadows in every fiber and grain, making the surface look touchable. Flat front light erases texture; side light celebrates it.

The universal reflective-surface rule

You don't light a shiny object — you light what it *reflects*. A polished ring shows a picture of its surroundings, so control the surroundings: big white cards for clean highlights, black cards to carve in definition. Once you think "what is this surface reflecting?" instead of "where do I point the light?", reflective products stop being scary.

Fingerprints and dust are the enemy

Reflective and dark surfaces show every speck. Wipe glass, metal, and black items with a microfiber cloth right before shooting, and check at 100% zoom. Cleaning in-camera beats cloning out dust for an hour in editing.

CHAPTER 7

A Fast Editing Workflow

Editing isn't cheating — it's the darkroom step every professional photo goes through. The goal for a shop is **speed plus consistency**: get one photo right, then apply that recipe to the whole batch so your catalog looks like it came from one studio on one day. Here's a workflow that takes minutes, not hours.

Edit one, sync the rest

1

Perfect your "reference" photo first.

Correct white balance (use that gray-card frame), set exposure, brighten the background, straighten, and finish. This one photo defines the look for the whole product line.

2

Copy the settings to the batch.

Any real editor (Lightroom, Capture One, and many free tools) lets you copy or "sync" adjustments across every selected photo shot in the same light. Your entire catalog gets consistent color and brightness in one click.

3

Spot-fix individuals.

Then walk through and nudge only the few that need it. Most won't, because you shot them consistently in the first place.

The core adjustments, in order



White balance

Set it first — everything else depends on accurate color. Eyedrop the gray/white card, or adjust until the product color matches real life.



Exposure & whites

Brighten so the product reads true and the background pushes toward clean white. For marketplace white, raise whites until the background hits 255 without haloing the product.

Straighten & crop

Level the horizon, square up the product, and crop to your marketplace's aspect ratio. Center the product consistently across the set.

Cleanup & sharpen

Remove dust and stray marks with the heal tool, then apply modest sharpening last, viewed at 100%. A little sharpening; never a lot.

Keep color accurate — it protects your bottom line

REMEMBER

Inaccurate color is the silent profit-killer. If the photo is a brighter, richer color than the real item, the buyer feels tricked, leaves a bad review, and returns it. Edit to make the product look its best *true* self — never a color it isn't.



Don't over-edit

Cranked saturation, heavy filters, and aggressive sharpening scream "amateur" and set false expectations. Your edit should make the product look like the best version of exactly what it is. If a buyer would be surprised unboxing it, you edited too far.

Resize to marketplace dimensions

Each platform has an ideal image size, and larger source files let zoom features show off your product's detail. As a rule, shoot at full resolution, then export a large, sharp copy — many marketplaces reward images at least 2,000 pixels on the long edge because it enables zoom-to-inspect. Export in the platform's preferred format (usually JPEG at high quality), at the aspect ratio the platform displays, so nothing gets awkwardly cropped by the site.



Batch export presets

Save an export preset per marketplace — dimensions, format, quality, sharpening for screen. Then exporting a finished catalog is one click. Set it up once; save yourself an afternoon on every product drop.

CHAPTER 8

Build a Consistent Brand Look & Shot List

A random pile of nice photos is not a brand. A *repeatable system* that produces the same set of shots for every product — that's a brand, and it's what turns a browsing stranger into someone who trusts you enough to buy. The tool that makes it repeatable is a shot list.

The five shots every product needs

For each product you list, capture this same set, in this same style, every time. It covers every question a buyer has and gives your listing a complete, professional feel.

Shot	What it shows	Buyer question it answers
Hero	The whole product, beautifully lit, styled or on clean white	"What is this and is it nice?"
Detail	Close-up of texture, material, craftsmanship, or a key feature	"Is it well made? What's the quality?"
Scale	In-hand, on-model, or beside a known object	"How big is it actually?"
Lifestyle	The product in use or in its natural setting	"How would this fit my life?"
Packaging / extras	How it arrives, variations, what's included, angles/back	"What exactly do I get?"



Try this: print your shot list

Tape the five-shot table next to your shooting spot. Before you break down the set for a product, tick off all five. You'll never again publish a listing that's missing the scale shot or the detail shot — the two most common gaps that cost sales.

What makes it a *brand* look

Consistency is the whole game. Pick your defaults and hold them across every product:

- ✓ The same background(s) — e.g. white for hero, one warm surface for lifestyle.
- ✓ The same lighting direction and softness in every shot.
- ✓ The same one or two recurring props, so your shop has a recognizable signature.

- ✓ The same editing recipe — color, brightness, and crop feel identical.
- ✓ The same shot order in every listing, so browsing your shop feels effortless.

CONSISTENCY = TRUST = SALES

When every listing in your shop shares one visual language, a shopper's brain reads it as "established, reliable, professional" before they've read a single word. That trust is what lets a home seller charge more than a faceless competitor — and it's built entirely with repeatable photos.



Build a template scene

Take a photo of your ideal setup — camera position, product placement, light and bounce, props. Save it as your "recipe." Next shoot, recreate it exactly. A template scene turns consistency from a discipline into a five-minute setup you can repeat forever, even months apart.

CHAPTER 9

From Photos to Sales

You've shot beautiful, consistent photos. Now let's make them *work* — because how you order, choose, and test your images decides whether all that effort actually moves your numbers. This is the final, highest-ROI step: turning great photos into clicks and clicks into orders.

The thumbnail wins or loses the click

On a search results page, your product is a tiny thumbnail fighting dozens of others for attention. If nobody clicks, nothing else matters. Your **main image** must be instantly clear and appealing at postage-stamp size.

1 Fill the frame with the product.

A big, clear product reads at thumbnail size; a small product in a busy scene disappears. Crop in so the item dominates.

2 Keep the main image clean.

Bright, sharp, uncluttered. On Amazon it must be pure white by rule; on Etsy/Shopify a clean styled shot often wins — test both.

3 Make it obvious what you're selling.

A confused shopper scrolls past. One glance should answer "what is this?"

Order your listing photos like a pitch

Once you've earned the click, your photo sequence should walk the buyer to "add to cart." Lead with the strongest image, then build the case:

1 Main / hero

Your best, clearest, click-winning shot. This is the one that shows in search.

2 Lifestyle / in-use

Immediately show it in context so they picture owning it.

3 Detail & scale

Prove quality and answer the size question before they have to ask.

4 Variations & packaging

Options, angles, and what arrives — close the last doubts.

A/B test your main image

You don't have to guess which photo wins — you can find out. Swap your main image for an alternative and watch what happens to your click-through and conversion over a couple of weeks; keep the winner. Some platforms have built-in experiment tools; even without one, changing the main image and tracking the before/after in your own stats tells you a lot.



Test one thing at a time

Change only the main image, and leave the title, price, and everything else alone during the test. Otherwise you won't know what caused the change. One variable, clear answer.

Mistakes that quietly kill conversions



The conversion-killer checklist

Dim or yellow photos that look cheap. **Inconsistent** images that look like a hobby, not a shop. **No scale shot**, so buyers can't judge size and don't risk it. **Cluttered backgrounds** that hide the product. **Only one photo**, when buyers want to inspect from every angle. **Over-edited color** that leads to returns and bad reviews. Fix any one of these and you'll usually see it in your numbers.



Your first move this week

Pick your single best-selling product. Reshoot its main image using this guide — window light, bounce card, tripod, f/8, clean background, filled frame. Swap it in. Watch your views and sales on that one listing for two weeks. That single before-and-after will convince you, in your own data, that photos are the highest-return work in your shop.

REMEMBER

Your buyer can't touch the product — so the photo does all the selling. Master light, shoot a consistent set, and put your best image forward, and better photos will out-earn every other upgrade you make to your shop.

Story Mode Guy

Photography guides for people who treat everything like it has a plot. · storymodeguy.com